missionaries in Serampore, and the first newspaper was started by an Englishman in Calcutta in 1780.

All these and other like changes crept in gradually, influencing the Indian mind and giving rise to the 'modern' consciousness.

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Only a small group was directly influenced by the thought of Europe, for India clung to her own philosophic background, considering it superior to that of the west. The real impact and influence of the west were on the practical side of life which was obviously superior to the eastern. The new techniques—the railway train, the printing press, other machinery, more efficient ways of warfare—could not be ignored, and these came up against old methods of thought almost unawares, by indirect approaches, creating a conflict in the mind of India. The most obvious and far-reaching change was the break-up of the agrarian system and the introduction of conceptions of private property and land-lordism. Money economy had crept in and 'land became a market-able commodity. What had once been held rigid by custom was dissolved by money.'

Bengal witnessed and experienced all these agrarian, technical,